

TV SHOW

Marvel's Hit-Monkey

★★★★☆ | When the trailer of Marvel's Hit-Monkey first dropped on YouTube three months ago, there was some curious Googling involved. Sure enough, something this out-of-the-box could only have debuted in a Deadpool story arc. Unlike a lot of Marvel's adapted works, Hit-Monkey isn't as prolific in print – which meant that there was an opportunity to see some original storytelling in the series.

Anti-heroes aren't exactly a fresh concept, especially in the Marvelverse. Characters like the Punisher, Ghost Rider, Deadpool, Venom – even, to an extent, the Hulk – have proven to be relatable to readers and watchers, whilst toeing the line between heroism and villainy. Not every good guy needs to be squeaky clean. Some of the most relatable people aren't righteous do-gooders. Enter: Monkey. A macaque on a quest for vengeance with nothing to lose.



The show begins with a quick one-episode tragic origin story then throws the viewers straight into the action-packed rough underbelly of Tokyo. Admittedly, it takes some time to really get a rhythm, but about three episodes in, Marvel's Hit-Monkey really gets the momentum going. While one can't avoid the absurdity of the premise, it surprisingly doesn't encumber the storyline. Yes, he's a monkey. Yes, he wears a suit. Yes, he's handy with a weapon. However, there's also a conscience, a code of honour, a tendency to love, and a struggle to find one's

spiritual self in an inherently violent world. The show is also occasionally self-aware, which allows for some meta moments in there.

The animation style works with the material and the action is set to match. The writing of the show seems to be spotty. At times, it seems like despite the adult themes and visuals, the writers were under the impression that it was a children's show when they submitted their first draft. While the character of the monkey hits the mark, Bryce the dead Hitman spirit guide could use some toning down. Oftentimes, Monkey's spectral companion pushes the funny banter into the realm of annoying. The show may justify the character by saying, "he's American," but after a point, it does veer towards too much.

All in all, the show does seem to be wasting some potential – it has the scope to be something refreshingly brilliant, yet comes across as playing it safe. However, it's a fun watch, and in no way boring or dull. People who've watched and followed Archer may draw some similarities between these two shows but on the whole, the show retains its own unique identity.

–Prakrit Dhondiyal

TV SHOW

Ozark S4 Part 1

★★★★☆ | Ozark Season 4, Part 1 picks up right where Season 3 left off. With former business partner and middle man Helen out of the way, the Byrdes now directly deal with Mexican drug cartel head Omar Navarro. With the body count piling up and the tensions rising between the Byrdes, Mexican drug cartel, opposing businesses and the FBI, the stakes are higher than ever before. The tension is palpable throughout the season and the plot is just riveting to follow. In more ways than one, this season is carried by



the two female leads – Wendy Byrde played by Laura Linney and Ruth Langmore played by Julia Garner.

Their acting chops overshadow most others this season. The new antagonist, Javi played by Alfonso Herrera, kicks things into high gear and proves to be a terrifying addition to the show. The season sets up part 2 and the season finale excellently. The ending features a major cliffhanger and we can't wait to see the ramifications of this plot point in part 2 of season 4. The cinematography is par excellence and the sound track melds seamlessly with the plot of the show. If you are someone who needs some kind of pay-off when watching a show, part 1 of season 4 will give you none. It's just constant ramping up of turmoil and tensions waiting to boil over in Part 2. Definitely don't give this show a miss. If you haven't watched it, now's a good point to start bingeing it.

–Dhriti Datta